the development of 'anthropogeography' or geography of humans.

1.5.8 History and Geography

History is a framework of events as per time and place. Geography attempts to study these events with reference to the physical earth and depict the places of historical events using thematic maps. Anyone who attempts to study any historical events of India should always integrate the temporal and the spatial phenomena of that period together to arrive at a conclusion.

1.6 Approaches to the Study of Geography

Geography has undergone several changes in its approach. The earlier geographers were descriptive geographers. Later, geography came to be developed as an analytical science. Today the discipline is not only concerned with descriptions but also with analysis as well as prediction. There are two distinct approaches or methods to study geography. They are:

1. Systematic approach and 2. Regional approach

1.6.1 Systematic Approach

Systematic or nomothetic approach was introduced by Alexander Von Humbolt, a German geographer (1769-1859). In this approach a particular phenomenon is considered for detailed understanding. The study of specific natural or human phenomenon that gives rise to certain spatial patterns and structures on the earth surface is called systematic study. Generally, systematic geography is divided into four main branches.

i. Physical Geography: Study of various elements of earth systems like atmosphere (air), hydrosphere (water), lithosphere (rock) and biosphere (life) and their distributions.

CASE STUDY



Born on 14 September 1769 Alexander Von Humboldt was a Prussian polymath, geographer, naturalist, explorer. Humboldt's quantitative work on botanical geography laid the foundation for the field of biogeography. Humboldt resurrected the use of the word *cosmos* from the ancient Greek and assigned it to his multi-volume treatise, *Kosmos*. He was the first person to describe the phenomenon and cause of human-induced climate change, in 1800. He described the Guanoco asphalt lake as "The spring of the good priest". Humboldt and Bonpland discovered dangerous electric eels, whose shock could kill a man. His stay in Ecuador was marked by the ascent of Pichincha and their climb of Chimborazo, where Humboldt and his party reached an altitude of 19,286 feet (5,878 m). This was a world record at the time. U.S President, Jefferson later referred to Humboldt as the most scientific man of the age.

ii. Biogeography, including environmental geography: It focuses on various kinds of forests, grasslands, distribution of flora and fauna, human-nature relationships, quality of the living environment and its implications for human welfare.

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